

Conquer The Hexagonal

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A 2-8 player tabletop board game for 3D-printed hex maps, dice, cards, and tactical area control.

Core Idea

Players lead rival expedition crews trying to conquer a shifting wilderness of rivers, reefs, forests, mountains, logs, and stones. The map is built from modular hex tiles, so every match is a new campaign. Players expand territory, complete objectives, fight over choke points, and use cards to change the board state. The winner is the first player to control enough of the map, or the player with the most control when the endgame triggers.

Theme Pitch

The world is fractured into hex provinces. Each player commands a small force trying to unify the land. Rivers slow progress, forests hide movement, mountains defend borders, and tactical cards create sudden reversals. Dice drive combat and risky pushes, but cards and positioning matter more than luck alone.

Components

Conquer The Hexagonal

- Modular 3D-printed hex map tiles
- 8 player leader pieces
- 8 sets of control markers or banners
- Resource markers
- 2 six-sided dice
- 1 terrain die or custom event die optional
- Deck of Tactic Cards
- Deck of Objective Cards
- Deck of Event Cards
- Round marker
- Rule summary cards

Player Count

- 2-4 players: tighter tactical game
- 5-6 players: political and shifting alliances
- 7-8 players: chaotic conquest mode with shorter victory threshold

Setup

1. Generate or build a hex map.
2. Place terrain features: rivers, stones, logs, islands, mountains, forests.
3. Mark starting zones evenly around the map edges.
4. Each player chooses a color and takes:
 - 1 leader piece
 - 12 control markers
 - 8 troop markers
 - 2 random tactic cards
5. Deal 1 secret objective card to each player.
6. Shuffle event deck and objective deck.
7. Each player places their leader on a valid starting hex.
8. Each player claims 2 adjacent starting hexes around their leader.
9. Determine first player by highest die roll.

Conquer The Hexagonal

Goal To Win

A player wins immediately if they meet one of these:

- Control a conquest threshold:
- 2-3 players: 18 hexes
- 4-5 players: 15 hexes
- 6-8 players: 12 hexes
- Complete 3 objectives
- Control all major strongholds or special zones on the map if used

If the event deck runs out or round limit is reached, the player with the most Victory Points wins.

Victory Points

- 1 VP per 3 controlled hexes
- 2 VP per completed objective
- 1 VP for each enemy leader defeated
- 1 VP for controlling each special location
- 1 VP bonus for longest connected territory chain

Board Terrain Rules

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- Plain: normal movement
- Sand: movement ends here if entered from water
- Forest: +1 defense
- Deep Forest: movement costs +1
- Mountain Stone: impassable to normal movement unless using a path card
- Mountain Rock: impassable and blocks ranged effects
- Water: must cross by bridge, log, boat card, or shallow ford rule
- Deep Water: impassable unless special ability/card
- Reefs: water hazard, failed crossing causes damage or retreat
- Stones: block movement through that hex
- Wooden Logs: may act as risky crossings

Turn Structure

Each player takes a full turn in clockwise order.

On your turn:

1. Draw Phase

- Draw 1 Tactic Card
- If you control a village or stronghold, draw 1 extra card or gain 1 resource

1. Command Phase

- Gain command points:
 - Base 3
 - +1 if leader is on a controlled village
 - +1 if you control 6 or more hexes
- Spend command points on actions

1. Action Phase

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Available actions:

- Move
- Claim
- Attack
- Fortify
- Build crossing
- Play card
- Recruit

1. End Phase

- Check objectives
- Discard down to hand limit
- Resolve end-of-turn effects

Actions

Move

- Spend 1 command point.
- Move your leader or one troop group up to 2 hexes.
- Movement into forest, deep forest, sand from water, or uphill may reduce movement by 1.
- Rivers can only be crossed at shallow points, logs, bridges, or by card effects.

Claim

- Spend 1 command point.
- If your unit occupies an uncontrolled hex adjacent to your territory, place a control marker.

Attack

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- Spend 1 command point.
- Attack an adjacent enemy hex.
- Both players roll 1d6.
- Add modifiers:
 - +1 attacker if attacking from higher ground
 - +1 defender in forest
 - +2 defender in mountain terrain
 - -1 attacker crossing water/log
 - +card bonuses if played
- Higher total wins.
- Loser removes 1 troop or retreats 1 hex.
- If defender retreats or is removed, attacker may claim the hex.

Fortify

- Spend 1 command point.
- Place a defense marker on a controlled hex.
- Hex gains +1 defense until conquered.

Build Crossing

- Spend 1 command point and 1 resource.
- Place a bridge marker across a river edge or stabilize a log crossing.

Recruit

- Spend 1 command point.
- Place 1 troop on a controlled village, capital, or starting zone.

Cards

Cards create tempo swings and help the game feel alive.

Tactic card examples:

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- Forced March: move one unit +2 hexes
- Ambush: +2 defense in forest
- Raft Crossing: cross one water boundary this turn
- Rockslide: block one mountain pass
- Scout Falcons: reveal 2 objective cards, keep 1
- Sabotage: remove a bridge or fortification
- Rally Cry: reroll one attack die
- Hidden Path: ignore deep forest penalty
- Flood Surge: one river edge becomes impassable for one round
- Reinforcements: recruit 2 instead of 1

Objective card examples:

- Hold 3 forest hexes
- Control both sides of one river
- Capture an enemy border hex
- Build 2 crossings
- Hold 5 connected hexes
- Eliminate 1 enemy troop in mountains
- Control 1 island and 1 village

Event card examples:

- Rising Waters
- Beast Migration
- Dense Fog
- Dry Season
- Supply Cache
- Landslide
- Night Raid
- Broken Bridge

Combat Model

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Keep combat simple so turns stay fast.

Basic resolution:

- Attacker rolls 1d6
- Defender rolls 1d6
- Add terrain and card modifiers
- Higher wins
- Tie goes to defender

Optional advanced combat:

- Leaders may take 1 wound instead of retreating
- Elite troops roll 2d6, keep highest
- Siege cards cancel fortify bonuses

Resources

Optional, but useful if you want stronger strategy.

Gain resources by:

- controlling villages
- completing objectives
- drawing resource events

Spend resources on:

- building bridges
- fortifying
- recruiting elites
- activating certain cards

Elimination

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Avoid player elimination too early.

If a player loses all controlled hexes:

- they are not out
- they respawn next turn at an unoccupied edge spawn
- they return with 1 leader, 2 troops, 1 random card
- they lose 1 VP

This keeps 8-player games alive.

Game Modes

Standard Conquest

- Fastest version
- First to conquest threshold wins

Campaign Control

- Play 6 rounds
- Highest VP wins
- Better for 5-8 players

Team War

- 2v2, 3v3, or 4v4
- Teams share victory
- No attacking teammates

King Of The Map

- One central fortress hex
- Gain VP each round for holding it

Conquer The Hexagonal

Suggested Round Length

- 2-4 players: 45-75 min
- 5-6 players: 75-110 min
- 7-8 players: 90-140 min

Balancing Suggestions

- Use fewer hexes per player in 7-8 player mode
- Increase choke points for tactical maps
- Use more open plains for shorter games
- Limit hand size to 5
- Limit attack actions to 2 per turn if games run long

Why This Works

- Modular map makes every game different
- 3D-printed terrain gives strong table presence
- Dice keep tension high
- Cards prevent deterministic play
- Area control gives a clear long-term goal
- Respawn rule prevents dead-player downtime

Short Rulebook Intro Text

“Conquer The Hexagonal is a modular conquest board game for 2 to 8 players. Build the map, command your faction, cross dangerous terrain, outplay rivals with tactics, and seize control of the land one hex at a time. Every board is unique. Every route is contested. Only one force will conquer the hexagonal frontier.”